Local variable & Global variable

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Local variables are variables that are declared inside a function or block. They only exist inside the specific function or block that creates them. They are unknown to other functions. They can be used only by statements that are inside that function or block of code. They cannot be accessed outside of the function.

Example:- In the following program the variables i, j & k are local to the main() function:-

```
void main()
{
    int i, j, k;  // local variables
    i = 10;
    j = 20;
    k = i + j;
    printf("\n i = %d, j = %d, k = %d", i, j, k);
    getch();
}
```

Global variables are defined outside a function. A global variable can be accessed by any function in the program. Global variables hold their values throughout the lifetime of the program and hence can be accessed inside any function in the program.

Example:

```
int a;  // global variable
void main()
{
    int b, c;
    b = 10, c = 20;
    a = b + c;  // global variable a being accessed inside this function
    printf("b = %d, c = %d, a = %d", b, c, a);
    getch();
```


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If there is a clash between global variable & local variable inside a function, then the local variable will take preference.

Example:-

```
int a=10; //global variable
void main()
{ int a=50; //local variable
  printf("a=%d",a); // This will produce output 50
  getch();
}
```

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